



Blind, Too Blind To See...

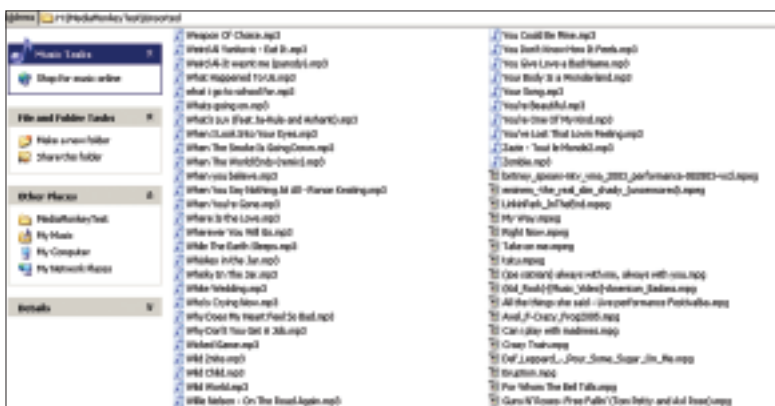
We created a folder, dumped all the stray MP3s and videos we had into it, and then went through it carefully to gauge what problems MM might face when sorting it all. We had a few duplicates, with just a letter or two differing in the filename. As with most MP3 files, ours were very poorly tagged—with some field or other missing in the ID3 tag. Then there were the videos, which were random enough to confuse anyone. Overall, we ended up with over 900 files (5.5 GB) of pure chaos. We then scattered these files all over our system's six partitions.

We started up MM, told it to search all drives, set it to search for audio and video formats, and then let it search. It found every file, but then this was expected. We then decided to first organise all the files by bringing them all into one folder (again).

After selecting all the files in the library, Tools > Auto-Organize Files... (or [Ctrl] + [R]) brought up the box we wanted. MM uses tags to denote variables—<Artist> for the artist, and so on. You can organise files easily this way by providing it a path to organise your files to. In our example we used "H:\MediaMonkeyTest\Unsorted\<Filename>". It recognised all the duplicates, and asked us to rename or specify a different path to organise those files to. We just unchecked one of each duplicate to ignore them—they were easy to spot, since they were highlighted in red.

Getting back the unsorted collection from across six partitions. We still did end up with a (very) few duplicates because of spelling errors in both the file name and the tags

Next we decided to try and properly sort the files. We chose H:\MediaMonkeyTest\



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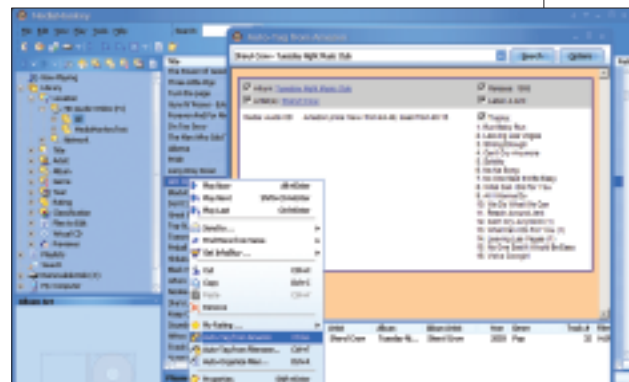
Sorted\<Artist>\<Album>\<Title> as our destination directory, and let MM do its thing. We ended up with over 500 folders! Apparently, ID3 tags can really play spoilsport. We brought all the files back to the "Unsorted" Folder and decided to see what would happen if we took a little trouble fixing ID3 tags first.

We also tried out MM's "Auto-Tag from Amazon" feature ([Ctrl] + [L]), which



seems to work only if both the artist name and album name tags are correct. Sometimes it did work with just the album name, and just never got the right results when the ID3 tag had no album name. What was good, though, was the fact that popular music was easily found, and a complete ID3 tag, including the album cover, could be added by just a single click per song.

After we found all the tags we could, and filled in the blanks in the ID3 tags with Unknown (if artist, album or song name were missing), we tried sorting again, and found that we had just about 430 folders this time—very



Using the tags from Amazon only works if the existing ID3 tag has an album name

good considering that our collection was filled with random stuff by around 450 artists anyway.

Yes, You Can Play With Madness

When it comes to organising, there's nothing left to say—we told you it would be easy. Remember, if you have your media files strewn about across several hard drives, MM is a very quick fix. If you really want to sort your collection immaculately, gather it all in one place and then use MM to quickly and easily edit ID3 tags and tag your music correctly—[Shift] + [Enter] in the library view will let you edit tags while browsing through your collection. If you do the tagging right, MM will sort it flawlessly for you.

Now apart from being able to organise your media collection, MM is also a very good audio player. With an interface that's not much different from any of the popular media players, you really should give MM a whirl!

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